

NORTHLINE BUILDING SUPPLY

Website Features Guide

Every feature of the prototype website and exactly how to reach it

Live website: <https://northline-prototype.onrender.com>

Version: Stage 1 prototype (client preview)

Date: September 2026

Business name, address, phone numbers, product details and product images shown on the website are placeholders until the final information is supplied.

Contents

1. Getting started (link, Demo button, accounts, test card)
2. Shopping (homepage, menus, search, filters, product pages)
3. Cart & checkout
4. Free quote requests
5. Contractor program
6. Customer account
7. Admin dashboard
8. Information pages
9. Coming in the next phase

1. Getting started

All links in this guide start with the live website address. Paths such as /shop mean <https://northline-prototype.onrender.com/shop>.

Opening the website

- Open <https://northline-prototype.onrender.com> in any browser, on a computer, tablet or phone.
- If the site has not been visited for about 15 minutes, the first load can take 30–60 seconds while it wakes up. After that it is fast.

The Demo button (quickest way to switch views)

- A dark **Demo** button sits at the bottom-right of every page.
- Click it and choose Regular customer, Approved contractor, Pending contractor, Rejected contractor, Administrator or Guest. You are signed in instantly.
- **Reset demo data** in the same menu puts everything back to the original sample data.

Demo accounts

Sign in at </account/login>. The password for every demo account is **Demo1234**. On the sign-in page you can also click an account to fill it in.

Account	Email	Use it to see
Administrator	admin@example.com	Full admin dashboard – add/edit products, orders, quotes, approvals
Approved contractor	priya.raman@example.com	Sees contractor (trade) prices on eligible products
Pending contractor	marcus.bell@example.com	Application under review – sees retail prices
Rejected contractor	elena.novak@example.com	Application not approved – sees retail prices
Regular customer	jordan.avery@example.com	Customer dashboard with orders, quotes and files
Staff (limited)	taylor.kim@example.com	Admin with only orders, quotes and customers

Test payments

- **4242 4242 4242 4242** – successful payment (any future expiry date, any 3-digit code).
- **4000 0000 0000 0002** – shows a declined payment.
- No real money is charged. Apple Pay and Google Pay show a simulated payment window. Interac e-Transfer creates an order waiting for payment.

Test delivery postal codes

- **L5A 1B2** – Local delivery (\$79) **M4C 1A1** – Metro (\$119) **N2L 3G1** – Extended (\$169)
- **V6B 1A1** – outside the delivery area (shows a message to choose pickup or request a quote).

2. Shopping (public website)

Feature	What it does	How to reach it
Homepage	Banner, value points, shop-by-category tiles, featured products, promotions, sale items, contractor section, free-quote steps, delivery & pickup info, showroom/contact area.	https://northline-prototype.onrender.com Open the website, or click the Northline logo from any page.
Announcement bar	Rotating messages at the very top (e.g. contractor pricing, current sale). Editable by admin.	Top of every page.
Main menu & Shop All menu	Links to Vinyl Flooring, Doors & Locks, Stairs, Bathroom, Plumbing, WPC Wall Panels, Deals and Contractors. Shop All opens a large menu of every department and category.	Dark bar under the header. Click the gold SHOP ALL button.
Mobile menu	Phone-friendly menu with departments, Free Quote, account and contact.	On a phone, tap the ☰ icon at the top-left.
Search	Searches product names, brands, SKUs, colours and descriptions. Understands common terms like "LVP".	/search?q=vanity Type in the search bar in the header and press Search.
All products	Full catalogue with filters and sorting.	/shop Menu → Shop All → Browse all products.
Category pages	One page per category (11 categories) with sub-type buttons.	/shop/vinyl Click a category in the menu or a tile on the homepage.
Filters & sorting	Filter by type, availability (in stock / special order), on sale, price range and brand. Sort by featured, price, newest or name. Results update instantly.	Left side of any category or shop page. On phones, tap the Filters button.
Deals & Sale	All products currently on sale, with original price crossed out.	/deals Click Deals in the main menu.
Product page	Photo gallery, brand, SKU, price, stock status, options, quantity, add to cart, request a quote, pickup/delivery info.	/products/harbour-oak-rigid-core-spc-plank Click any product card.
Product options	Choose colour, size, finish or door handing. Price and pictures update to match.	/products/coastline-waterproof-spc-plank On a product page with options, e.g. Coastline SPC Plank or 30" Shaker Vanity.
Square-footage calculator	Enter room sizes (feet or metres) or total sq. ft., choose 0/5/10/15% waste, and it calculates the boxes/panels needed and cost. "Use N boxes" sets the quantity.	/products/harbour-oak-rigid-core-spc-plank On flooring and wall-panel product pages, under the price.

Feature	What it does	How to reach it
Stock labels	In Stock, Low Stock (with quantity left), Out of Stock (with expected restock date) and Special Order (with lead time).	Shown on every product card and product page.
Sale & contractor prices	Sale items show the sale price with the regular price crossed out. Approved contractors see a "Contractor price" label.	Any product page; switch to Approved contractor with the Demo button to compare.
Request-a-Quote products	Products without a fixed price show "Request a Quote" instead of a price.	/products/estate-collection-european-oak E.g. Estate Collection European Oak, Staircase Refacing Package.
Specs, installation, warranty & documents	Tabs with full specifications, installation notes, warranty info and downloadable PDF spec sheets / install guides.	Scroll down on any product page.
Related products & accessories	Matching items, e.g. vinyl → underlayment and trims; door → locks; vanity → mirror and plumbing parts.	Bottom of product pages.

3. Cart & checkout

Feature	What it does	How to reach it
Mini cart	Slides in after adding an item, showing items, subtotal and buttons for Checkout, View cart and Quote cart.	Click Add to cart, or the cart icon at the top-right.
Cart page	Change quantities, remove items, see savings and contractor pricing, and continue shopping.	/cart Cart icon → View cart.
Delivery checker	Enter a postal code to see the delivery fee before checkout.	/cart On the cart page, below the order summary.
Request quote for this cart	Turns everything in the cart into a quote request. The cart is kept.	/quote?from=cart Cart page → Request quote for this cart.
Guest checkout	Buy without creating an account.	/checkout Cart → Proceed to checkout.
Pickup	Free pickup; choose the location and see hours, instructions and when it will be ready.	Checkout → step 2 → Pickup.
Delivery	Delivery fee calculated from the postal code. Large orders show "Delivery fee to be confirmed". Choose a preferred date (subject to confirmation) and add instructions.	Checkout → step 2 → Delivery.
Payment	Credit card (Visa, Mastercard, Amex), Apple Pay, Google Pay or Interac e-Transfer. Demo mode only.	Checkout → step 4 → Payment.
Taxes & totals	Subtotal, delivery, HST and total shown live on the right.	Checkout → Order summary.
Order confirmation	Order number, pickup/delivery details, payment details, items and totals. e-Transfer orders show payment instructions.	Appears after Place order.

4. Free quote requests

Feature	What it does	How to reach it
Free Quote form	Customer details, project address, customer type, products needed, colours/styles, quantities, measurements, installation yes/no, delivery or pickup, preferred date, extra details, preferred contact method.	/quote Click the gold Free Quote button in the header.

Feature	What it does	How to reach it
File uploads	Attach photos, measurements, floor plans or PDFs (JPG, PNG, WEBP, HEIC, PDF – up to 10 MB each, 8 files). Wrong file types are rejected with a message.	Free Quote form → Photos, plans & documents section.
Quote from a product	Starts a quote with that product and its chosen options already added.	Product page → Request a quote for this item.
Quote confirmation	Shows a reference number like Q-2026-0010, a summary and next steps. A confirmation email is simulated.	Appears after Submit quote request.

5. Contractor program

Feature	What it does	How to reach it
Contractor landing page	Explains trade benefits and how approval works.	/contractors Click Contractors in the main menu.
Contractor application	Contact details, business name, type, years in business, HST/business number, licence, address, preferred contact and login password.	/contractors/apply Contractors page → Apply now.
Application status	Shows Pending, Approved or Not Approved with a timeline.	/contractors/apply/submitted After applying, or Account → View details on the contractor banner.
Contractor pricing	Approved contractors automatically see contractor prices on eligible products. Guests, regular customers and pending/rejected contractors never see them.	Demo button → Approved contractor, then open any vinyl product.
Contractors-only prices	Some products show prices only to approved contractors; everyone else sees Request a Quote.	/products/solid-core-sound-dampening-door-slab E.g. Solid Core Sound-Dampening Door Slab.

6. Customer account

Feature	What it does	How to reach it
Create an account	Name, email, phone, password, company (optional), HST number (optional), preferred contact method, billing and delivery address.	/account/register Header → Sign in → Create an account.
Sign in	Email and password; demo accounts listed for one-click fill.	/account/login Header → Sign in.
Dashboard overview	Open orders, active quotes, files, addresses, recent orders and quotes, contractor status.	/account Header → My account → My dashboard.
Personal & company details	Edit name, phone, company, HST number and communication preferences.	/account/profile Dashboard → Personal & company.
Addresses	Billing address and multiple delivery addresses (add, edit, delete).	/account/addresses Dashboard → Addresses.
Orders	Order history with status; open an order for full details and status timeline.	/account/orders Dashboard → Orders.
Quotes	Quote history with status (Submitted, Under Review, Additional Info Required, Quoted, Approved, Declined) and quoted amount.	/account/quotes Dashboard → Quotes.

Feature	What it does	How to reach it
Project files	All photos and documents uploaded with quotes, with download links.	/account/files Dashboard → Project files.
Settings & security	Change password; two-step verification shown as coming soon.	/account/settings Dashboard → Settings & security.

7. Admin dashboard

Sign in as **admin@example.com** (password **Demo1234**) or use the Demo button → Administrator. All sections are in the dark menu on the left. Changes appear on the website immediately.

Feature	What it does	How to reach it
Dashboard overview	Sales for the last 30 days, open orders, open quotes, pending contractor applications, 14-day sales chart, items needing attention, recent orders, quotes, stock alerts and notifications.	/admin Sign in as admin, or left menu → Dashboard.
Products – list	All products with prices, stock and status; search and filter by category or stock.	/admin/products Left menu → Products.
Add a product	Create a new product: name, SKU, brand, category, descriptions, prices, stock, specs, options, images, documents, related items, badges, featured on homepage.	/admin/products/new Products → Add product (top-right).
Edit a product	Change any product detail. A preview shows what guests, pending contractors and approved contractors will see.	/admin/products Products → click a product name.
Categories	Edit category names, descriptions and sub-types.	/admin/categories Left menu → Categories.
Product variations	See all products with options (colour, size, finish, handing) and jump to edit them.	/admin/variations Left menu → Product variations.
Images & documents	Gallery of all product images and PDFs.	/admin/media Left menu → Images & documents.
Pricing	Quickly change retail, sale and contractor prices and price visibility (public / contractors only / hidden) for every product.	/admin/pricing Left menu → Pricing. Edit a row and click Save.
Inventory	Change stock quantity, stock status and restock date; filters for low/out of stock and special order.	/admin/inventory Left menu → Inventory. Edit a row and click Save.
Orders	All orders with filters by status; open an order to change its status, confirm a delivery fee and notify the customer.	/admin/orders Left menu → Orders.
Quote requests	All quotes; open one to see customer, project, products and files, set status, add quoted amount and message the customer.	/admin/quotes Left menu → Quote requests.
Customers	All customer and contractor accounts, with spend, orders, quotes, addresses and internal notes.	/admin/customers Left menu → Customers.

Feature	What it does	How to reach it
Contractor applications	Review applications and Approve, Reject or return to Pending, with a note emailed to the applicant.	/admin/contractors Left menu → Contractor applications → Review.
Contact submissions	Messages from the Contact page; mark as New, In progress or Resolved.	/admin/messages Left menu → Contact submissions.
Delivery settings	Delivery zones by postal code, fees, free-delivery threshold, lead times, large-order rule, tax rate and a postal-code tester.	/admin/delivery Left menu → Delivery settings.
Pickup settings	Pickup locations, addresses, hours, instructions and ready times.	/admin/pickup Left menu → Pickup settings.
Promotional banners	Edit the announcement bar messages and homepage promo tiles; add or remove banners.	/admin/promotions Left menu → Promotional banners.
Website content	Edit homepage headline and text, contractor and quote section text, About Us text.	/admin/content Left menu → Website content.
Email notifications	Turn each email type on/off, set the admin email, and read every email the site has generated.	/admin/emails Left menu → Email notifications.
Staff & permissions	Add staff, choose Administrator or Staff, and pick which sections each staff member can access.	/admin/staff Left menu → Staff & permissions.
Integrations	Status of payments, email, analytics, storage and future connections (POS, QuickBooks, CRM, SMS, Facebook/Instagram).	/admin/integrations Left menu → Integrations.

8. Information pages

Feature	What it does	How to reach it
Contact page	Address, phone, text number, email, opening hours, contact form and map area.	/contact Footer → Contact Us.
Delivery & Pickup policy	How pickup and delivery work, with current delivery zones and fees.	/policies/delivery Footer → Delivery & Pickup.
Returns, Privacy, Terms	Placeholder policy pages ready for final wording.	/policies/returns Footer links.
Newsletter signup	Customers can subscribe to deals and news.	Footer → enter email → Subscribe.

9. Coming in the next phase

These are planned for the final build and are not active in the prototype:

- Real online payments (payment account in the business's name, e.g. Stripe).
- Real emails to customers and staff (currently shown in Admin → Email notifications only).
- Permanent database, so products, orders and quotes are never reset.
- Direct photo and PDF upload from the admin product editor.
- Final business details, logo, real product catalogue and product photos.
- Password reset, two-step verification, saved products, invoices and reorder.
- Own domain name, analytics, SEO and final testing before launch.